

WHAT'S YOUR MONEY STORY?

So far, we've looked at the theory behind Money Stories. Now, it's time to think about your own Money Story. To help you do that I want to talk about the work of Dr Brené Brown.

If you haven't heard of Brené, she's a research professor at the University of Houston and has spent more than a decade studying vulnerability, courage, authenticity and shame. Her 2010 Ted Talk, 'The Power of Vulnerability', has had over 45 million views and her book *Daring Greatly* has sold more than a million copies.

Now, most people don't have a shame and vulnerability professor in their 'top five' list of people they'd love to have dinner with—perhaps she's on mine because her research on vulnerability and shame is so intrinsically linked with finances and perhaps it's because I just want to geek out on numbers and data with her and she pulls no punches. What I do know is that so much of her work has a direct link to how we relate and behave financially. It's why when it comes to unpacking your Money Story, I want to start with a quote by Brené: 'When we deny the story it defines us. When we own the story, we can write a brave new ending'.

This quote summarises so beautifully why I believe we need to recognise, own and, where necessary, rewrite our Money Stories. By understanding and owning our Money Stories, we can take back control over our finances. Because the truth is, whether we acknowledge it or not, someone or something is currently directing our behaviour.

When Brené talks about owning your story, she's really talking about vulnerability, or feeling exposed, a state I see many people I work with